DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 7

Customer service representative

Profession 7 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A customer service representative answers questions, solves problems and keeps customers informed by email, chat or phone. Good service turns a complaint into a repeat customer.

What professionals do every day

Answers tickets and messages, looks up orders, explains policies, escalates technical issues and follows up until the case is closed.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Customers judge a business by how its problems are handled. Clear, fast replies reduce refunds and bad reviews.

- Replies that do not answer the question.
- Cases that stay open with no owner.
- Tone that escalates an upset customer.

Skills you need

- Clear written and spoken English.
- Empathy and calm tone.
- Ticket tools.
- Policy knowledge.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Zendesk	Support tickets and help centre	Trial (check current offer)	Subscription	www.zendesk.com
Freshdesk	Support desk	Free plan (check current)	Paid plans	freshdesk.com
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	Free personal account	Paid business plans	workspace.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Write three reply templates for common questions.
Intermediate	Triage ten tickets by urgency.
Advanced	Write one escalation note that a technical team can act on.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Support for an online store.
- **Intermediate:** Help desk for a software product.
- **Advanced:** Chat support for a travel firm.

Client-ready portfolio project

A support pack for a fictional online store: reply templates, a triage sheet for ten tickets, and an escalation note.

Worked example

Worked example. A customer writes that a parcel is late. The reply acknowledges the delay, gives the tracking status, states the next update time and offers the next step without guessing a delivery date.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Triage and escalate

Business problem: Ten tickets arrive in one hour. Two involve a payment problem and one involves a possible safety issue.

Steps

1. Sort each ticket by urgency: safety and payment first, then delayed orders, then general questions.
2. Reply to the general questions using the templates.
3. Escalate the payment and safety tickets with a clear note.
4. State the response time promised for each.

Expected output: The sorted list, replies and escalation notes.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Safety and payment issues need the fastest route to someone who can act. Escalation notes that include the facts and the customer's request save the next person from asking again.

Common mistakes

- Promising refunds or dates you cannot control.
- Copying customer data into personal chats.
- Closing a ticket without confirming the customer is satisfied.
- Using AI-drafted replies without checking facts.

Freelancing opportunities

- Support shifts for online businesses.

- Help desk setup and reply templates.
- Briefs for 'customer support', 'chat support', 'help desk'.

Learning resources

AI-ASSISTED REPLIES

AI tools can draft a reply quickly. Check the facts, remove any promise you cannot keep, and never paste confidential customer data into a tool your client has not approved.

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Zendesk help (verify)

Part of **Master Freelancing: Admin and Business Support**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.